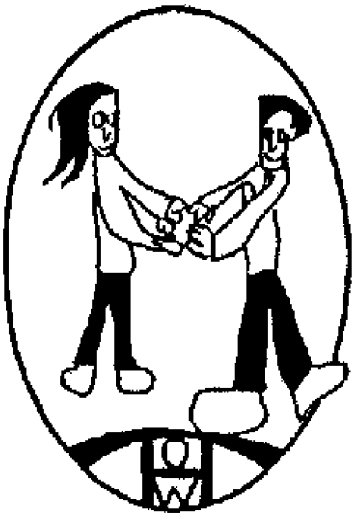
# Howbridge Infant School



# First Aid Policy 2026

Date adopted by by Governing Body: Summer 2026

## Aims:

The aim of this policy is to set out guidelines for all staff in school in the administering of First Aid to children, employees or visitors. This policy shall be shared with all employees during their induction to ensure they are familiar with the school's first aid procedures.

The Governors are committed to the Local Authority's procedure for reporting accidents and recognise their statutory duty to comply with the Reporting of injuries, diseases and dangerous occurrences regulations 1995.

## What is first aid?

First aid can save lives and prevent minor injuries becoming major ones. Under health and safety legislation employers have to ensure that there are adequate and appropriate equipment and facilities for providing first aid in the workplace.

## First aid and medication:

Health and safety legislation places duties on employers for the health and safety of their employees and anyone else on the premises. All staff are trained in basic first aid, with some members of staff nominated as Appointed Persons. These staff have more in depth first aid training. We also have some staff with current paediatric first aid training. All staff are trained by St John Ambulance.

Posters displaying the names and locations of first aiders are on display around the school.

## Our first aid kits:

These comply with the Health and Safety (First Aid) Regulations 1981 and British Standard – BS 8599-1:2011. All kits are checked regularly to ensure that they are fully stocked and that all items are within their expiry dates. Midday staff are responsible for first aid at lunchtime and have their own lunchtime bags containing basic first aid equipment.

**We have a defibrillator located in the school hall for children and one in the school office for adults.**

## Accident books:

All staff have access to the accident form to record any injuries to children. These are completed and brought to the school office to be scanned and attached to the pupil electronic records. The paper copies are then shredded. All accident forms are reviewed at least half termly by a member of the Senior Leadership Team to identify any potential or actual hazards, safeguarding or behaviour concerns.

Our forms keep a record of any first aid treatment given by first aiders and other members of staff. These forms MUST be completed in pen, completed on the same day of the incident, and include:

- The date and place of the incident.
- The name and class number of the injured or ill person.
- Details of the injury or illness and first aid given.

The information on the forms can:

- Help the school identify accident trends and possible areas for improvement in the control of health and safety risks;
- Identify safeguarding and behavioural concerns
- Support children's well being
- Be used for reference in future first-aid need assessments;
- Be helpful for insurance and investigative purposes.

Parents must be informed of any serious accidents, injuries sustained and/or first aid treatment given to their child whilst in school. Staff must be aware of the General Data Protection Regulations and not allow parents to view personal information other than that relating to their child and must not allow parents to take photographs other than of their own child. It is not standard practice to give parents copies of the school's accident forms. However, if a parent requests a copy of the accident form then this will need to be authorised by a member of the Senior Leadership Team.

## Administration of medicines:

This applies to all pupils, including those who do not have an individual health care plan. Parents must complete an Administering Medication Form to authorise the school to give medicine to their child. Medicines will be safely stored in the school office with the exception of Asthma pumps, insulin or other emergency medication including epipens which are located with the children so that they can be swiftly administered. All medication administered is added to the pupil electronic record and then paper copies are shredded. This will include date and time, the child's name and class, details of the medication administered including dosage and name of the member of staff who administered the medicine. The parents will receive a slip detailing the date and time that the medicine was administered. Any parent can request that their child is given prescription medicine in school. The school will only accept medicine that has been prescribed by a GP or hospital doctor. In most cases it is sufficient for antibiotics to be administered once a day by the school.
With the exception of emergency medication, e.g. asthma pumps and adrenaline auto injectors, medicine should be taken home at the end of the day and returned to school if necessary the following day. Parents are encouraged to ask their GPs for medical prescriptions that fit around the school day. No pupil will be given medicine without parental consent unless there is a clear emergency and ambulance / emergency personnel are in attendance.

Prescribed medicines must be in date, prescribed by an NHS doctor and provided in the original container with dosage instructions. Parents must regularly renew the school supply of medicines and be responsible for visiting the GP to collect repeat prescriptions. At the end of the school year the school will return all medicines in store to the parents. The school will not be held responsible for any side-effects due to the correct administration of prescribed medication. If the administration of prescribed medication requires medical knowledge, individual training will be provided for the relevant member of staff by a health care professional.

## Medical emergencies:

All members of staff who have contact with pupils who have known medical conditions will be informed about the best course of action if a child becomes seriously ill and needs emergency treatment. The child and the parents will be informed about the school's arrangements and there will be details in the plan if appropriate.

The school will call an ambulance before contacting parents if a child becomes seriously ill – this applies to all children and not only those with health care plans. The school will arrange for a competent member of staff to travel to hospital in an ambulance and act in loco parentis until a parent arrives. The member of staff in loco parentis will have the right to sanction emergency procedures as advised by medical staff in the ambulance or at the hospital.

## Sickness:

Our policy for the exclusion of ill or infectious children is discussed with parents. This includes procedures for contacting parents, or other authorised adults, if a child becomes ill while in the school.
We do not provide care for children who are unwell, e.g. have a temperature, or sickness and diarrhoea, or who have an infectious disease. Children with head lice are not excluded, but must be treated to remedy the condition. Parents are notified if there is a case of head lice in the school.

Good hygiene practice concerning the clearing of any spilled bodily fluids is carried out at all times.

## Treatment of injuries:

Following an accident, the first aider is to take charge of the first aid administration/emergency treatment commensurate with their training.
Following their assessment of the injured person, they are to administer appropriate first aid and make a balanced judgement as to whether there is a requirement to call an ambulance.
The first aider should call an ambulance on the following occasions:

- In the event of a significant injury or head injury
- If bleeding cannot be controlled
- In the event of a period of unconsciousness
- Whenever a fracture or break is suspected
- Whenever the first aider is unsure of the severity of the injuries
- If identified in the individual's health care plan

## Treatment of head injuries to children:

Children often fall and bang themselves, and thankfully most bangs to the head are harmless events and can be dealt with by the supervising adult by applying a cold compress (wet tissue or cloth) for the child's own comfort. Parents/Carers must be contacted if the child has a visible or grazed bump to the head. All head bumps must be recorded on an accident form and a letter sent home informing parents of possible symptoms to look out for. It is the responsibility of the first aider dealing with the head bump to inform a member of the class staff.

## Emergency first aiders should be sought if the child:

- becomes unconscious;
- is vomiting and shows signs of drowsiness;
- has a persistent headache;
- complains of blurred or double vision;
- is bleeding from the nose or ear; and/or
- has pale yellow fluid from the nose or ear.

If any of the above symptoms occurs in a child who has had a bang to the head, urgent medical attention is needed. Emergency services and the parents should be contacted.
In the event of an accident in which the child cannot stand up unaided, he/she should be left in the position that he/she was found (even if this is in the toilets or playground) so long as it is safe to do so and the emergency first aider must be called immediately to assess the situation.

## Emergency medicines

Emergency medicines will be stored in a safe location in the child's classroom in the tall cupboard, top shelf in the bathroom area.

Types of emergency medicines may include:

- Injections of adrenaline for acute allergic reactions
- Inhalers for asthmatics
- Injections of Glucagon for diabetic hypoglycemia
- Hydrocortisone injection

Other emergency medication ie. Rectal diazepam or Buccal Midazolam for major seizures will be stored in accordance with the normal prescribed medicines procedures (see storage section).